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“ The open source domain is gaining a lot of traction.

As a company (Wind River Systems), we have always contributed substantially to the open source community. This, coupled with our desire to understand the OSI initiatives in the Indian context, were some of the reasons that brought us to the CIO Summit 2010.

Experiences at the CXO Summit 2010: Overall, it was a useful summit. It was very interesting to see the open source domain gaining a lot of traction.

Trust with Linux and open source: Our company has the reputation of being one of the leaders in the embedded systems domain. We have embraced Linux and other open source solutions such as Android, MeeGo, Ubuntu and Red Hat. We offer our customers yet another very powerful tool for Linux and Android, called Workbench.

Why I feel open source rocks for businesses: As against proprietary products, open source offers huge advantages in terms of community participation. Also, it eliminates any form of dependency, and brings full control to the user who can manage it internally. Hence, we offer optimised Linux and Android solutions to our customers and community, and encourage the use of open source.

A word of caution: The field of open source technology still poses a challenge in the domain of support and optimised solutions. That's why, sometimes, companies end up spending a lot of time and resources on leveraging these solutions well.

A wish-list for the CXO Summit 2011: I am keen on learning more about open source usage in different verticals, and also about the embedded segment, through the CIO Summit.



“ The OSI CXO Summit was a great platform for business networking.

I have always enjoyed such technical events and sessions related to computing. It's an added bonus, if they involve open source as well. That apart, I attended OSI to network with business heads and players in the open source domain.

Trust with Linux and open source: I have been using Linux and open source tools since my college days, and also in many of the companies that I have worked in. I have always recommended Linux and open source software for software development to many of my peers and friends.

Why I feel open source rocks for businesses: I believe that the following factors make the use of open source conducive for companies:

- Its favourable cost
- Almost everything, including the source code, and documentation of data, is open to the public
- It allows people to share knowledge via forums and websites, without the fear of licence costs, which means less expense and difficulties for training.

A word of caution: Sometimes, the open source licences may not support your company's best interests. Besides, for a home PC, I feel Windows would be a better option, due to its easier learning curve and better gaming. Linux needs more maturity in these aspects.

A wish-list for the CXO Summit 2011: I suggest that the organisers consider holding parallel sessions to ensure that none of the interesting sessions are missed. Also, it would be good if the attendees are provided with free Wi-Fi access.



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